

QUESTION 1

Wine 1

a) Cap Classique, Constantia

The pale lemon colour, fine persistent mousse and notes of elderflower, lemon curd and brioche indicate a Traditional Method sparkling wine. The medium body, very dry style and high, crisp acidity point to a cool climate and suggest either Champagne, England or South Africa. However there is a pure core of some riper Meyer Lemon which moves away from Old World and points to New World as more likely. The acidity, though high, is not quite as elevated as the cooler climates of Champagne or England and points more to a Cap Classique style from Western Cape in South Africa. The 12.5% alcohol and very dry finish, 2g/l dosage, are consistent with this.

b)

A pale coloured, quite complex, very refreshing, very dry, Blanc de Blancs style of sparkling wine. The wine is a very good quality Vintage style which shows a very direct and pure core of citrus fruit. It shows excellent balance between the very high acidity, medium body, creamy mousse and quite pure lemon fruit concentration. It has underlying complexity from subtle brioche notes from around 30 months on lees and the finish is quite long. It stops short of the broader, richer and more autolytic Prestige styles, suggesting a very good quality Vintage.

c) The quite complex, autolytic nature with 30 months on lees and overall very good quality suggest a price of around \$55. The pure core of citrus fruit and yeasty complexity suggest it would compete globally with other Traditional Method sparkling wines, particularly cooler climate styles rather than other New World examples, such as England and Champagne but at a more competitive price point than these two. The Blanc de Blancs style mean it will be more niche internationally than a straight NV blend but it could find export opportunities in markets that like the Extra Brut, more austere styles such as UK, Netherlands and Scandinavia. It still may require hand selling in these markets as Cap Classique, though very popular in domestic market, may need to be recommended outside its local origin.

Wine 2

a) England

The pale golden colour, elegant mousse and combination of rose petal, strawberry, green apple and elderflower together with the broad quite rich yeasty palate point to a Traditional Method wine from Pinot Noir, Chardonnay and Meunier. The 12% alcohol, full, rounded style with emphasis more on yeast than fruit suggest an Old World over new World origin and point to Champagne or England in particular. The quite concentrated palate and fairly rich autolytic profile are consistent with both but the more green apple fruit and extremely high and very racy acidity point to the even cooler climate of England over Champagne.

b) A full bodied, broadly autolytic, extremely racy, super refreshing and complex NV Style.

The wine is very good quality with a richness and breadth on the palate, and a high level of autolytic complexity. The full rounded mouthfeel and concentrated yeast and brioche notes point to at least 3 years on lees to give this complex style. The balance, too, between the very high crisp acidity, delicate mousse, full body and quite high fruit intensity is excellent and the finish is quite long. It just stops short of the even richer and more autolytic Vintage styles pointing to a very good NV.

c) The rich, broad autolytic style with very high acidity and quite a long finish suggest this is a wine that will compete head on with Champagne. Closest in style than other Traditional Method sparkling wines to NV Champagne and at a similar price point, \$100, it may struggle to gain a foothold in many export markets. The wine may therefore be in more limited distribution on the global stage compared to its local market where loyalty to these styles is strong. However, with

Champagne prices edging up, this style stands more chance to increase its presence abroad. It already has a strong foothold in the Nordic countries, particularly Norway where these very crisp, dry styles are popular. Volume will always be much smaller than Champagne so it will never compete in multiple export markets. However, the increasing reputation and overall high consistent quality will allow further international gains to be made especially in the USA, Canada and other Commonwealth countries.

Wine 3

a) Champagne, France

The pale golden colour, very fine and delicate mousse, with very intense rich marmite yeasty character and very long length immediately point to Champagne. The high, taut acidity, 12.5% alcohol, extremely autolytic mouthfeel, very dry style and very high quality are all consistent with Champagne.

b) A highly complex, very dry, extremely autolytic, mature, Vintage style. One that has still potential to hold despite its maturity.

The very broad mouthfeel and high level of fruit and yeast concentration point to an outstanding quality wine. The mousse is extremely fine, delicate yet persistent and is extremely well balanced with the high acidity, very dry profile and full body. The very high degree of complexity coming from the very intense marmite characters from around 15 years on lees give this wine a depth and length to offset the very crisp acidity. The finish, too, is very long and it clearly has potential to age further and points to an excellent quality, Vintage Cuvée.

c) The extremely complex, yeasty and autolytic character with the very fine persistent mousse and long finish point to a Vintage style and one likely retailing for around \$150. This very intense yeasty style from over a decade on lees together with the very high quality, Extra Brut profile and high price point means it will appeal to a very narrow band of consumers who understand and recognise the style. This late disgorged style is very niche and would only be suited primarily to markets that love these very 'marmite' styles, the UK in particular. It would also give it a point of difference in a global context to other Champagne Houses who rarely produce this style. The exceptional quality means it will no doubt garner high praise from wine critics and international competitions which would allow opportunities for sales in broader international markets.

QUESTION 2

Wine 4

a)

The pale golden colour and pronounced notes of lemon, peach, butter and hazelnut suggest a wine made from Chardonnay. The very pristine fruit with no noticeable phenolics point to whole bunch pressing and the very fine integrated toast and boot polish character with a savoury overtone suggest fermentation in new French oak barrels, likely with natural yeast. The high yet rounded acidity indicates malolactic was undertaken. The quite pronounced bread dough and pastry notes together with the very high-toned vanilla point to ageing on lees in the same new French oak barrels (500 litres) for at least 12 months to give this very steely, flinty style. The highly reductive character indicate the wine was topped up during this time and likely without batonnage. The 12 months ageing in barrel suggests natural sedimentation and this together with the very high quality indicates likely bottling with no fining or filtration.

b) An excellent quality, single vineyard.

The wine shows an intense core of very precise, citrus fruit. It is highly complex with very integrated fine toast notes from barrel fermentation and ageing in new French oak. This is further enhanced by the very creamy and reductive style from extensive time on lees, 12 months. The wine too is extremely saline and mineral, allowing the terroir notes to shine through, all in line with an excellent quality, single Vineyard wine. The finish too is long, all confirming the excellent quality.

The wine is still very primary in nature with mostly lemon, apple and peach notes and the pale golden colour suggests a youthful wine of 2-3 years old. The high degree of concentration will allow the wine to improve over the next 5-6 years developing more complex dried fruit and nutty

characters. The reductive style together with the high, crisp acidity will allow it to then hold a further 7-10 years before decline.

c) Côtes du Jura

The highly complex barrel fermented and oak aged style could immediately suggest Côte d'Or Burgundy. However, the extremely high acidity, modest 12.5% alcohol and very reductive saline and chalky style are more in line with very high quality Chardonnay from the cooler climate of Côtes du Jura.

Wine 5

a) The medium-sweet style and light, frizzante mousse point to an Ancestrale sparkling style. The quite crisp acidity and grapey and orange blossom nature point to a wine likely based on Muscat. The quite pure pristine citrus characters indicate the fermentation was likely started in stainless steel tank to preserve the primary fruited characters. The low 8.5% alcohol, medium sweet style, 40g/l RS, and frizzante rather than Spumante style points to a continuation of the initial fermentation in bottle on the same yeast. The lack of any yeasty characters point to a fresh Pet Nat rather than autolytic style and the absence of any sediment or cloudy appearance suggest the wine was disgorged prior to the final sealing with crown cap to give this pristine, fresh, medium sweet, Pet-Nat style.

b) An acceptable quality Pet Nat, retailing for around \$13.

The wine is quite aromatic with fresh grape and orange blossom aromas and some Muscat varietal typicity. The mandarine fruit is very well balanced with the medium yet quite crisp acidity, medium sweet style and 8.5% alcohol. The frizzante petillance is well integrated with the citrus fruit too and balanced with the quite crisp acidity. The wine, though, is quite simple in style with no real complexity with only a very slight textural note from the yeast suggesting more an acceptable than good quality wine. The finish, too is quite short. This is a very 'clean' pristine, disgorged style of Pet Nat without the complex yeasty characters of a more minimal intervention style, all confirming the acceptable quality..

The very primary notes indicate a wine that is very youthful, only 1-2 years old. The light fruit concentration and immediate citrus approachability indicate this is a wine to be drunk young, and will not improve. However the quite high acidity and very clean and not too funky nature point to a wine that will probably keep for a further 6 months in bottle before decline.

c) Pet Nat, Vin de France

The pale lemon colour and very floral and grapey characters suggest a wine based on Muscat and therefore France as most likely. The Ancestrale Nature, very clean Pet Nat style, 40g/l RS, 8.5% alcohol and high crisp acidity would seem to suggest Languedoc but the style precludes any AOC designation so it is likely a generic Vin de France.

Wine 6

a)

The pale golden colour, bone dry style, 15% alcohol and very pronounced sourdough and yeasty nose points straight to a Fino style and a wine therefore based on Palomino. The lack of any varietal aromatics point to a warm fermentation at around 20-22°C and the lack of any residual sugar and 15% alcohol point to fortification with neutral grape spirit, 96%, at the end of fermentation. The very pronounced yeasty and sourdough characters with a very saline finish point to ageing for a very extended time under flor for at least 8 years. The combination of fresh and dried citrus fruit characters point to this long ageing in solera and the richer body and more textured, yeasty mouthfeel indicate an En Rama style and therefore bottling without filtration.

b) A very good quality, En Rama style.

The very pronounced yeasty characters with notes of bread dough, umami, almond and pastry point to very long flor ageing, 8 years similar to a Pasada style. The wine is very complex with the combination of citrus flavours and the very saline flor notes and the finish too is fairly long. It is clearly a step up from a generic Fino style and all confirms the very good quality.

The wine is already at its peak with well integrated flor, yeasty and citrus flavours. It is extremely well balanced between the modest acidity, 15% alcohol and quite full body and clearly but will not improve from here. It will though keep for at least another 1-2 years due to the high level of flor and acetaldehyde but beyond that may lose some citrus freshness.

c) Sanlucar da Barrameda

The bone dry style, 15% alcohol, modest acidity and very yeasty character point to a complex Fino Style. The very yeasty characters and more pronounced sourdough notes point to a very long ageing under flor in a more humid environment and suggest Manzanilla over Fino. The very saline finish is also consistent with this and therefore Sanlucar de Barrameda as the origin.

QUESTION 3

Wine 7

a) Rivesaltes VDN , Grenache

The quite deep tawny intensity and sweet style could immediately suggest Port and the Douro as origin. However the wine is focussed entirely on dried raspberry and dried cherry notes with no hint of black fruits indicating a wine based entirely on Grenache unlike the blended red and black fruit flavours of ruby Port. The alcohol too is 17% in line with the lower fortified VDN styles as is the medium acidity and the wine is slightly less sweet at 70g/l all again in line with VDN.

The tawny colour and more dried fruit than primary characters point to an oxidative rather than reductive style and suggest Rivesaltes over Maury or Banyuls as the most likely origin as these are the most predominant styles in this Appellation.

b) The notes of dried red fruits, with raspberry cherry and a touch of pepper spice point to Grenache as the variety. The 17% alcohol and 70g/l RS suggest fortification with neutral grape spirit, 96%, after around 4 days of fermentation. The tawny colour and quite pronounced dried fruit characters point to ageing in old oak barrels, 600 litres for around 6 years with no topping up to give this oxidative style.

c) A good quality, Tuilé style.

The wine shows a reasonable degree of dried fruit concentration and has complexity from the oxidative dried fruit and coffee flavours, It is well balanced between the medium sweet style, 17% alcohol and moderate concentration and the finish too is medium. It lacks the extra level of oxidative intensity of the better Hors d'Age styles suggesting a good quality generic VDN.

The quite deep tawny colour and oxidative nature points to a mature wine of around 10 years old. The wine is already fully developed and will not improve but it does have enough concentration to keep a further 4-5 years before decline all backed up with the medium, fresh acidity.

Wine 8

a) Douro, T. Nacional, T.Francesa, T.Roriz, T Barroca

The deep, ruby colour, 20% alcohol, 105g/l RS and pronounced nose of plum, dark cherry and clove point straight to Port and therefore Douro as the origin. The medium yet refreshing acidity, full body and sweet and reductive style are consistent with Ruby style of Port and confirm Douro as the origin. The combination of red and black fruit flavours point to a blend of T.Nacional, T.Francesa and T.Roriz the latter providing the moderate tannic backbone, all further in line with Port and Douro as the origin.

b) The combination of red and black fruit flavour points to a blend of Touriga Nacional, Touriga Francesa and Tinta Roriz. The deep ruby colour, medium, smooth tannins, 20% spirit alcohol and 105g/l RS point to rapid extraction, possibly by mechanical plungers, before fortification after 48 hours with aguardente, 77% grape spirit. The medium yet smooth tannins and quite intense, rounded nature suggest ageing for around 5 years in a reductive environment, large wooden vats. The clean pristine appearance with no trace of sediment suggests filtration before bottling.

c) A very good quality LBV.

The wine is very well balanced between the medium, smooth tannins, 20% abv and 105g/l RS. There is quite an intense depth of red and black fruit concentration and some complexity from the cinnamon and clove notes. The finish too is quite long all in line with the very good quality.

The extremely harmonious balance of bramble fruits, medium acidity and medium, integrated tannins point to a wine that is at its peak and one of around 5-6 years old. The fruit, though quite intense and concentrated, will not develop positively from here. It does, though, have the medium acidity and the moderate tannins to keep for another 2-3 years before losing freshness.

Wine 9.

a) Recioto della Valpolicella,. Corvina/Corvinone/Rondinella

The quite deep ruby colour, 13% alcohol, 120g/l RS, kirsch and dried cherry character point to a red passito style and a Recioto from Valpolicella. The very pronounced plum and cherry notes are consistent with a majority of Corvina/ Corvinone in the blend and the floral and peppery overtones indicate a complement of one-third Rondinella. The very fresh acidity to underpin the high 120g/l sugar and 13% alcohol are constant with the Recioto styles from Valpolicella as is the very good quality and touch of VA.

b) The high degree of sugar 120g/l together with pronounced kirsch characters and 13% alcohol point to extended drying of the grapes, likely up to 4 months to give this very sweet and complex style. The very primary fruit characters point to fermentation in old oak vats or inert vessels with fermentation being arrested before the end, probably naturally due to the high sugar and relatively high alcohol. The very primary nature but with a rounded mouthfeel and quite rich toasty overtones suggests ageing in old oak casks for around 24 months before bottling.

c) Very good quality, single vineyard.

The wine has a pure core of concentrated cherry fruit achieved from the extended drying. It is extremely well balanced between the high sugar, 13% alcohol and high, racy acidity. The finish too is quite long and complex with only a touch of VA, all testament to the very good quality, likely single vineyard.

The ruby colour, mostly primary bramble and cherry notes with a touch of kirsch colour point to a relatively young wine of around 6-7 years old. There is enough intensity for it to improve over the next 3-4 years when it will develop more dried cherry and more intense kirsch complexity. It should then hold for a further 4-5 years all supported by the high sugar, 13% alcohol and high, crisp acidity.

Wine 10

a) Niagara Peninsula, Riesling

The pale lemon colour and pronounced nose of green apple, lemon balm and peach with very high, racy acidity point straight to Riesling. The very pure core of citrus and stone fruit with a touch of tropical melon are consistent with Riesling and point more to New World, Australia or Canada over Germany. The medium sweet style with 90g/l and 12% alcohol and very high crisp acidity are more consistent with cooler climate Canada than the rarer but sweeter style examples from more temperate Australia. This together with the lack of any mushroom or viscous notes from botrytis are consistent too the the warmer and lake-influenced climate of Niagara Peninsula and point to a Late Harvest rather than noble rot style from this location.

b) The very pure citrus fruit character, medium sweet style with no hint of honey, or fungal botrytis suggest the sweetness was achieved by late harvested grapes rather than noble rot. The quite high level of sugar, 90g/l point to at least a further 2 weeks drying on the vine post normal ripeness. The very primary fruit characters point to fermentation in stainless steel rather than oak and the 12% alcohol and 90g/l indicate the fermentation stopped before the end, probably by chilling and addition of SO₂ rather than naturally. The preservation of the bold primary characters indicate ageing also in inert vessel for another 6 months before final bottling.

c) A very good quality, super clinical and very precise Late Harvest wine.

The combination of quite high sugar 90g/l and 12% alcohol indicate a high level of ripeness in the late harvested grapes. This quite high sugar is perfectly balanced by the very high acidity and provides a very direct and focussed style in combination with the well-defined fruit. Complexity comes from a wide array of primary flavours, apple blossom, lemon and peach with a tropical overtone. The finish too is quite long all consistent with a very good Late Harvest style.

A youthful style as seen by the pale lemon colour and primary citrus and stone fruit characters indicating a wine of 2-3 years old. The wine has enough weight to improve over the next 1-2 years when it would start to develop some dried citrus and petrol notes. The 90g/l RS, very high acidity and quite intense, pure concentration will allow it to keep for at least another 3 years before decline.

Wine 11

a) Madeira, Malvasia

The pale amber colour, 19% alcohol and pronounced nose of dried citrus peel, desiccated almond and caramel point straight to Madeira. The high sugar 105g/l RS point to a sweeter style of Fortified Wine consistent with Madeira and Malmsey therefore as the variety. The very high, lively acidity and oxidative, caramel overtones from "heating" during ageing all further confirm Malmsey Madeira.

b) The pale amber colour, 105g/l RS and notes of dried citrus peel, coffee, salted almond and honey point to the sweetest styles of Madeira and indicate Malvasia as the grape variety. The 105g/l RS and 19% alcohol point to arrested fermentation by fortification with 96% neutral spirit, early on in fermentation, after around 2 days. The quite oxidative note and harmonious caramel overtones indicate ageing in the gentler Canteiro method rather than the more baked Estufagem. The medium finish points to ageing in oak casks for around 5 years before bottling.

c) A good quality, 5 year old Malvasia.

The wine shows excellent integration between the high acidity, 105g/l RS and 19% alcohol. Complexity is achieved through the gentle caramelisation from the Canteiro ageing and the integrated and quite oxidative flavours from 5 years in cask. The finish too is medium pointing to a 5 year old style.

The pale golden colour and oxidative, caramel nature indicate this wine is already fully developed. It will not improve but the combination of 105g/l RS, 19% abv and canteiro/oxidative ageing, together with the high crisp acidity indicate it will hold for at least 10 years.

Wine 12

a) Jerez, Palomino, Pedro Ximenez

The quite deep mahogany colour, 20% alcohol, medium, fresh acidity and very oxidative, sweet style with 134g/l RS point straight to Cream Sherry and therefore Jerez as the origin. The dried citrus characters with overt raisined and sultana notes point to a blend of Palomino and Pedro Ximenez. The very oxidative nature and mature style indicate long ageing in solera all consistent with Sherry and Jerez.

b) The deep mahogany colour, 20% alcohol and absence of any yeasty characters indicates fortification at the end of fermentation to a high strength with neutral spirit, 96%, to prevent the development of flor. This quite deep brown colour and pronounced oxidative characters indicate ageing in solera for at least 12 years. The very sweet style 134 g/l RS point to blending with at least 20% PX after the 12 years. The harmonious style points to further ageing in a final solera after blending for at least 3 years to enable this high degree of integration.

c) Very good quality, Cream Sherry.

The high and quite luscious sugar, 134g/l is counterbalanced by a quite high degree of dried fruit, raisined concentration and medium yet quite refreshing acidity. There is quite a high degree of complexity, too, from the dried fruits, caramel, coffee and raisined notes and the finish is quite long. It stops short of the very best VOS or VORS style but is still a very good wine nonetheless.

The deep mahogany colour, dried fig and caramel notes with no primary characters point to a fully developed wine, probably already one around 15 years old. It has reached its peak and will not improve but has the quite intense weight, luscious sweetness, and high alcohol to keep for decades, all supported by the medium yet freshening acidity.